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SENIOR PROGRAMMER

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Learning Ruby on Rails wasn't just academic in 2013; it was a tool I desperately needed. Working off-shifts in Fermilab's Main Control Room, facing complex processes dependent on manual steps, I saw chances for automation and sane defaults. Rails, via Hartl's tutorial, was my entry point. That initial spark – cutting through complexity to improve people's lives – has driven my career since.

That drive led me from Accelerator Operations into Controls, identifying friction points and building bridges. I co-authored a "[Rookie Book](#)" that became a standard textbook (clear communication matters) and co-founded a Coding Club (sharing knowledge accelerates). When our system lacked modern tools, I didn't complain; I found a mentor and built the needed JS/Python libraries, forging relationships to make it happen. This feels like being a "Manager of One" – seeing a need and building the tool.

My path wasn't purely Rails. I've wrestled legacy C++, introduced Ansible for automated deployments (a sanity-saver), implemented Slack and GitHub Enterprise division-wide, and hosted seminars clarifying complex topics. Each step reinforced the value of good tooling, communication, and the relentless pursuit of better. Advocating to open-source our 40-year-old ACNET control system wasn't just symbolic; it recognized developer craft and embraced transparency.

Now, I co-lead a significant part of ACORN, a \$160M DOE project to modernize our control system towards cloud-native standards and browser UIs, removing decades of band-aids. A key part was hiring our first UX expert and championing Figma and a design system – because great software serves users and developers.

Why leave Fermilab? Because I've admired 37signals from afar. Your focus on pragmatic, beautiful code, compressing complexity, building your tools, and trusting developers resonates deeply. Coming back to Rails recently (building a Pokemon app for my kids) felt like returning home – recalling the joy and productivity of a framework built with programmer happiness and strong opinions. After years of solving complex problems, Rails' elegance feels more valuable than ever.

This may seem like a leap, but it feels right. I'm excited to contribute to Basecamp, HEY, and open-source. Focused teams and embracing craftsmanship appeal to me. My background in building tools, navigating complex systems, fostering collaboration, and seeking simpler solutions seems a strong fit for what you're looking for.

Thank you for considering my application. I hope my voice comes through. I'm eager to learn more.

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